“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 14

A Description of the Divine Madness: the Lord Hastens to Caṭaka Hill

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 Now I shall tell a small part of all that Gaurāṅga did with His mind, body and intelligence in the bewilderment born of separation from Kṛṣṇa.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya, the Supreme Lord Himself! Glory, glory to Gauracandra, the life of His devotees!

3 Glory, glory to Nityānanda, the life of Caitanya! Glory to Advaitācārya, most dear to Gaura!

4 Glory to Svarūpa, to Śrīvāsa and to all the Lord’s devotees! Grant me the strength to describe Śrī Caitanya.[1]

5 The Lord’s divine madness in separation is a mood so profound that no one can understand it, however wise he may be.[2]

6 Who can describe what we cannot even understand? Only one to whom Caitanya gives the power can understand it and describe it.

7 These pastimes are revealed in the diaries (*kaḍacā*) of these two, Svarūpa Gosāñi and Raghunātha dāsa.

8 At that time these two lived at Mahāprabhu's side, while all the other diarists lived in distant places.

9 Experiencing His pastimes moment by moment, these two recorded them in their diaries, sometimes briefly and sometimes at length.[3]

10 Svarūpa is the author of the sūtras, and Raghunātha the author of their explanation (*vṛtti*). I describe them more fully, in the manner of a *pāǰi-ṭīkā* (an introductory commentary).[4]

11 Hear with faith this description of His feelings (*bhāva*): you will come to understand them and gain the treasure of prema.

12 The state that came upon the gopīs when Kṛṣṇa went to Mathurā arose in the Lord in His separation from Kṛṣṇa.

13 As Rādhā lamented when She saw Uddhava, so little by little the Lord too began to lament in His divine madness.[5]

14 Steeped in Rādhikā's mood, the Lord always had Her sense of self (*abhimāna*); in that mood He knew Himself to be Rādhā.[6]

15 Such is divine madness (*divyonmāda*) — why wonder at it? In *adhirūḍha-bhāva*, the highest stage of love, divine madness pours itself out in incoherent words.[7]

16 "When the *bhāva* called *mohana* reaches a certain indescribable state, there arises in it something wondrous that resembles bewilderment, and this is called divine madness (*divyonmāda*). Its varieties are held to be many, such as *udghūrṇā* and *citra-jalpa*." (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, 14.190)

17 One day, as Mahāprabhu lay asleep, He saw Kṛṣṇa's *rāsa-līlā* in a dream.

18 Kṛṣṇa's beautiful form was bent in three places, the flute at His lips; He wore yellow cloth and a garland of forest flowers — the enchanter of Madana, the god of love.

19 The gopīs danced in a circle, and in the middle the son of the king of Vraja danced with Rādhā.

20 Seeing this, the Lord became absorbed in that rasa and thought, "I have found Kṛṣṇa in Vṛndāvana!"

21 When Govinda saw that the Lord was late in rising, he woke Him. On waking, the Lord understood that it had been a dream, and He was filled with sorrow.

22 Out of bodily habit He completed His daily duties, and at the proper time He went to see Jagannātha.

23 He would behold Jagannātha from behind the Garuḍa pillar, while in front of Him people in their hundreds of thousands took darśana.

24 An Oriyā woman who could not see through the crowd climbed onto the Garuḍa pillar and, with her foot on the Lord's shoulder, gazed at Jagannātha.

25 Seeing this, Govinda hastily tried to pull her down, but the Lord forbade him.[8]

26 "Foolish fellow (*ādivasyā*)! Do not remove this woman. Let her look at Jagannātha as much as she wishes."[9]

27 The woman hurriedly climbed down, and when she saw Mahāprabhu she bowed at His feet.

28 Seeing her eagerness, the Lord began to speak: “Jagannātha has not given Me such eagerness![10]

29 Her body, mind and life are absorbed in Jagannātha; she does not even know that she has put her foot on My shoulder.[11]

30 Oh, how fortunate she is! I bow to her feet. By her grace may such eagerness arise in Me too.

31 Before, whenever I beheld Jagannātha, I saw in Him the son of the king of Vraja Himself.

32 Absorbed in the vision of My dream, My mind has stayed in that state, and wherever I look I see the One with the flute at His lips.”[12]

33 But now, at the sight of the woman, the Lord came back to outward consciousness and saw the forms of Jagannātha, Subhadrā and Balarāma.

34 His mind became like that of one who sees Kṛṣṇa at Kurukṣetra: “How have I come to Kurukṣetra? And where is Vṛndāvana?”[13]

35 Like one who has lost a jewel he had just found, He was in turmoil, and He returned, dejected, to His residence.

36 Sitting on the ground, He scratched at the earth with His nails; a Gaṅgā of tears flowed from His eyes, and He saw nothing at all.

37 “I found the Lord of Vṛndāvana, and I have lost Him again! Who has taken My Kṛṣṇa? Where am I now?”

38 Absorbed in the dream, the Lord's mind overflowed with love; when external consciousness returned, it was as if He had lost a treasure.

39 Like a madman the Lord sang and danced; He bathed and ate merely out of bodily habit.

40 When night came, He would sit with Svarūpa and Rāmānanda and open to them the feelings of His heart.

41 "My mind found the wealth of Acyuta and lost it again. In its grief it abandoned its house, the body, took up the ways of a *kāpālika* yogī, and went off to Vṛndāvana with its band of disciples, the senses."[14]

42 Having lost the jewel He had found and remembering its qualities, Mahāprabhu was overwhelmed with anguish. Clasping Rāya and Svarūpa by the neck, He cried, "Alas! Hari! Hari!" His composure gave way, and He grew restless.

43 "Hear, My friends, of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness! Craving it, My mind has given up the duties of society and of the Vedas, become a yogī and turned beggar.

44 My mind's earrings of pure conch-shell are the circle of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, fashioned by Śuka the craftsman. Wearing those earrings, it holds the gourd-bowl of thirst, and the bag of hope hangs from its shoulder.[15]

45 The patched quilt of anxiety is wrapped about it, its body is grey with dust and ash, and to every word it answers with the raving cry, "Alas, Kṛṣṇa!" On its arm are the twelve bangles of agitation, on its head the bag of longing, and for want of alms its body has wasted away.[16]

46 The yogīs Vyāsa, Śuka and others have described in the *Bhāgavata* and other scriptures all the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa, the stainless Self, in Vraja; those songs (*tarjā*) it recites without cease.

47 Making the ten senses its disciples and taking the name “Mahā-bāul”, it set off with them. Leaving everything — its own home, My body, and the great wealth of sense enjoyment — it went to Vṛndāvana.[17]

48 The subjects of Vṛndāvana — all beings, stationary and moving, the trees and creepers — live as householders. It begs in their homes and eats fruits, roots and leaves; this is how it lives with its disciples.

49 The gopīs relish the nectar of Kṛṣṇa’s qualities, form, taste, fragrance, sound and touch. The disciples, the five senses, bring the remnants of their meal, and on those alms they sustain their lives.

50 In the corner of an empty bower-pavilion it stays with its disciples, practising yoga in meditation on Kṛṣṇa. Longing to see Kṛṣṇa, the stainless Self, face to face, it keeps vigil all night in meditation.[18]

51 Separated from Kṛṣṇa, My mind became a yogī in its sorrow, and in that separation the ten states came upon it. Overwhelmed by them, it fled, and its dwelling, My body, stands empty.”[19]

52 In separation from Kṛṣṇa ten states arise in the gopīs; those same ten states arose in the Lord.

53 “In this separation there are ten states: anxious thought, sleeplessness, agitation, emaciation, uncleanliness of body, incoherent talk, disease, madness, fainting and death.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, 15.167)[20]

54 Night and day the Lord was distraught by these ten states: now one state would arise, now another, and His mind found no rest.

55 Having said this, Mahāprabhu fell silent, and Rāmānanda Rāya began to recite verses.[21]

56 Svarūpa Gosāñi sang of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, and together the two brought the Lord somewhat back to external awareness.

57 In this way they passed half the night, and then they had the Lord lie down in the inner room.

58 Rāmānanda Rāya then went home, and Svarūpa and Govinda both lay down at the door.

59 Mahāprabhu stayed awake all night, loudly chanting the names of Kṛṣṇa.

60 Hearing no sound, Svarūpa opened the door: the three doors were still shut, yet the Lord was not in the room.

61 Not seeing the Lord, everyone grew anxious, and in great distress they all went about looking for Him.

62 On the north side of the Siṁha-dvāra (the Lion Gate) there is a certain spot, and there Caitanya Gosāñi lay where He had fallen.

63 Finding Him, Svarūpa Gosāñi and the others were overjoyed; but when they saw the Lord's condition, they grew anxious again.

64 The Lord lay there, five or six cubits long; His body was senseless, and no breath stirred in His nostrils.

65–66 Each of His arms and legs had grown three cubits long. The joints of His bones had come apart: there remained only the skin, and the warmth that showed He was alive. His hands and feet, neck and waist, His bones and all His joints had each come apart by a span.[22]

67 Only skin covered the joints, which lay drawn out. Seeing the Lord in this state, everyone was stricken with grief.

68 Saliva and foam were at the Lord's mouth, and His eyes were turned upward. Seeing this, all the devotees felt as if life were leaving their bodies.

69 Then Svarūpa Gosāñi, together with the devotees, loudly chanted the name of Kṛṣṇa into the Lord's ear.

70 After a long while the name of Kṛṣṇa entered His heart, and with a thunderous cry of "Haribol!" the Lord sprang up.

71 As He regained consciousness, the joints of His bones came together, and His body became just as it had been before.

72 Raghunātha dāsa has described this pastime of Mahāprabhu in his *Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa*:

73 "Once, in Miśra's house, in intense separation from the son of the lord of Vraja, His arms and legs grew unnaturally long, for the beauty and the joints of His limbs had given way. Rolling on the ground in utter distress, He wept piteously in a voice choked with feeling. That Śrī Gaurāṅga, rising in my heart, makes me mad with joy." (Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa, 4)[23]

74 Finding Himself at the Siṁha-dvāra, the Lord was astonished, and He asked Svarūpa, "What are you doing? Why?"[24]

75 Svarūpa said, "Get up, Prabhu, and come to Your own room. There I shall tell You everything."

76 Saying this, he held the Lord and took Him to His room, and there began to tell Him all about the state He had been in.

77 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu was greatly astonished and said, “I remember nothing of it!

78 I only see that My Kṛṣṇa is present: He appears like a flash of lightning and vanishes.”

79 Just then the conch (*pāni-śaṅkha*) of Jagannātha sounded, and Mahāprabhu bathed and went for darśana.[25]

80 Thus I have described the Lord’s extraordinary transformations; whoever hears of them is struck with wonder.

81 Such things are not seen in this world, nor do we hear of them in the scriptures; yet the crest-jewel of sannyāsīs reveals such feelings.

82 Ordinary people cannot believe in feelings (*bhāva*) that lie beyond the scriptures and beyond this world.[26]

83 Raghunātha dāsa always stayed with the Lord. I write what I heard from his own lips, with full faith in it.

84 One day, as Mahāprabhu was going to the sea, He suddenly caught sight of the Caṭaka hill.[27]

85 Taking it for Govardhana Hill, the Lord was overcome with feeling and ran towards it.

86 “Ah, friends, this hill is the best of Hari’s servants! Thrilled by the touch of the feet of Rāma and Kṛṣṇa, it honours Them, together with Their cows and companions, with water to drink, fine grass, caves, and bulbs and roots.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.21.18)[28]

87 Reciting this verse, the Lord rushed on with the speed of the wind. Govinda ran after Him but could not catch up.

88 A cry went up, and there was a great uproar. Everyone, wherever he was, got up and ran.

89 Among them were Svarūpa, Jagadānanda, Gadādhara Paṇḍita, Rāmāi, Nandāi and Śaṅkara Paṇḍita.

90 Purī Gosāñi and Bhāratī Gosāñi came to the seashore, and the lame Bhagavān Ācārya followed very slowly.

91 At first the Lord went like the wind; but on the way He was seized by stupor (*stambha*) and had no strength to move.

92 At every pore the flesh rose in a tiny swelling, and on it the hairs stood on end, like the filaments of a kadamba flower.

93 From every pore sweat poured out with streams of blood. His throat gurgled, and He could not utter a single syllable.

94 His two eyes filled, and tears flowed endlessly, as if the streams of the Gaṅgā and the Yamunā had met the sea.

95 His colour faded, and His body turned white as a conch. Then a trembling arose in Him, like waves on the sea.

96 Trembling all over, the Lord fell to the ground. Then Govinda came up to Him.

97 With water from the waterpot (*karaṅga*) he sprinkled the Lord's whole body, and with the outer cloth he fanned Him.

98 Svarūpa and the others arrived there; seeing the Lord's condition, they began to weep.

99 They saw the eight sāttvika transformations in the Lord's body and were amazed at these wondrous signs.[29]

100 They sang loud saṅkīrtana right at the Lord's ear and bathed His body with very cool water.

101 When they had sung kīrtana in this way many times, the Lord suddenly rose, crying "Haribol!"

102 Joyfully all the Vaiṣṇavas cried, "Hari! Hari!", and an auspicious sound arose, filling the four directions.

103 Rising, Mahāprabhu looked here and there in astonishment, but what He longed to see, He could not see.

104 Seeing the Vaiṣṇavas, the Lord came half into external consciousness and began to say something to Svarūpa Gosāñi:

105 "Who has brought Me here from Govardhana? I had found Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, but I could not go on seeing them.

106 Today I went from here to Govardhana to see whether Kṛṣṇa was grazing the cows.

107 Kṛṣṇa had climbed Govardhana and was playing His flute, and all around the hill the cows were grazing.

108 Hearing the sound of the flute, Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī came, beautifully dressed and adorned, with all Her sakhīs.

109 Kṛṣṇa took Rādhā with Him and entered a cave, and some of the sakhīs wanted to gather flowers.[30]

110 Just then all of you raised an uproar, seized Me and carried Me back here.

111 Why did you bring Me here, only to give Me pain for nothing? I had found Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, but I could not go on seeing them."

112 Saying this, Mahāprabhu wept, and seeing His condition, the Vaiṣṇavas wept too.

113 Meanwhile the two, Purī and Bhāratī, arrived. Seeing them both, Mahāprabhu was filled with reverence.

114 When He came fully into external consciousness, the Lord offered His respects to them both, and the two embraced Mahāprabhu with love.

115 The Lord said, "Why have you two come so far?" Purī Gosāñi said, "To see Your dancing."

116 At Purī's words the Lord was embarrassed, and He went with all the Vaiṣṇavas to the bathing place at the sea.

117 After bathing, Mahāprabhu returned home and, together with everyone, partook of mahā-prasāda.

118 Thus I have described the Lord's mood of divine madness (*divyonmāda*), whose power even Brahmā cannot describe.

119 Raghunātha dāsa has described the pastime of the Lord's running to the Caṭaka hill in his *Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa*:

120 “Near Nīlādri He beheld the Caṭaka hill, a king among hills. ‘Ah! From here I am going to Vraja, to see Govardhana, the lord of hills!’ He cried, and ran like one mad, with His own companions following after Him. That Gaurāṅga, rising in my heart, makes me mad with joy.” (Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa, 8)[31]

121 Who can understand these extraordinary pastimes of the Lord, this play of Mahāprabhu?[32]

122 I have told this only briefly, just to point the way. Whoever hears it attains the feet of Kṛṣṇa.[33]

123 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The second line is the same as Madhya 12.3; translated as there. ↩
2. Heading in the edition: without Gaura’s mercy even a great scholar cannot understand the Lord’s transcendental divine madness. ↩
3. *Anubhāṣya*: these two constantly experienced Mahāprabhu’s pastimes and wrote them down, now briefly, now at length, in the form of diaries rather than formal books. ↩
4. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the author sets out both accounts, enlarging them a little, after the manner of a *pājī-ṭīkā*, which “fluffs out” the thoughts of the original source as one fluffs out cotton. ↩
5. *Anubhāṣya*: for Śrī Rādhā’s lament see the *Bhramara-gītā*, Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.47.12–21. ↩
6. Heading in the edition: the Lord is filled only with the mood of Śrī Rādhā in separation from Kṛṣṇa, and so in Him there is no desire of Kṛṣṇa for the enjoyment of union (*sambhoga*). *Anubhāṣya*: though Śrī Gaurasundara is Kṛṣṇa Himself, His body is joined with Śrīmatī Rādhikā, and so He was always immersed in Her mood. ↩

7. *Divyonmāda* is the highest manifestation of *mahābhāva*, not worldly madness. ↩
8. *Anubhāṣya*: to climb the Garuḍa pillar is an offence to a Vaiṣṇava, and to set one's foot on the Lord's shoulder is an offence to the feet of Bhagavān; fearing this, Govinda hurried to bring the woman down. ↩
9. *Anubhāṣya* refers to Antya 10.116, where *ādivasyā* is explained as "unfortunate", "unwise", "foolish", "fickle", "impatient". ↩
10. Heading in the edition: seeing her ardent love, the Lord speaks humbly of Himself and glorifies her as His guru. *Anubhāṣya*: *ārti* is a burning desire to see; longing to see Jagannātha, she forgot what is proper and improper and, without knowing it, set her foot on the shoulder of the all-worshipful Mahāprabhu. ↩
11. Heading in the edition: a lesson — not to look upon a servant of Kṛṣṇa with sense-born knowledge, by outward marks such as "woman" or "man". ↩
12. Verses 28–32 are the Lord's words, as in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition (the quotation closes after verse 32). Some editions read verse 31 as *pūrve āsi' yabe … jagannāthe dekhe*, which makes verses 31–32 the narrator's account. ↩
13. Heading in the edition: seeing Vāsudeva at Kurukṣetra, the Lord is filled with the mood of a gopī separated from Śyāma. ↩
14. Heading in the edition: a verse spoken by Gosvāmipāda. *Anubhāṣya* (on verse 51): the *kāpālikas* are a kind of yogī who wander with a human skull; they do not follow the Vedas and are not Vaiṣṇavas — only the comparison with their ways is taken here. ↩
15. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: these are the earrings of the *Bhāgavatam*. An ordinary yogī carries a gourd water-pot and a begging bowl; the yogī that is the Lord's mind has made its bowl from the gourd of thirst for Kṛṣṇa and hung on its shoulder the bag of hope, "I shall attain Kṛṣṇa." ↩
16. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the twelve bangles are the eight *sāttvika-vikāras*, the surge of the mind, trembling, sighing, restlessness and anxious thought. *Anubhāṣya*: a variant reads *lobhera jhulnī māthe*; *jhulnī* is a cloth that may cover the head. ↩
17. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Bāul yogīs take ten disciples each. ↩
18. *Śūnya*, "empty": according to the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*, a bower where Kṛṣṇa is not. Heading in the edition: the state of sleeplessness (*jāgara*). ↩
19. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the empty dwelling of the body is an image of fainting (*pralaya*), with which the ten states end. Heading in the edition: the states of disease (*vyādhi*), fainting (*moha*) and death (*mṛtyu — pralaya*); *citra-jalpa*. ↩

20. *Anubhāṣya*: these are the ten states in the separation called *pravāsa*, when the beloved has gone to a distant land; *moha* is bewilderment of mind (*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: fainting). ↩
21. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition (p. 1017) reads *mauna hailā*, "fell silent". Heading in the edition: Rāmānanda Rāya recites verses suited to the Lord's mood of separation and to the hour. ↩
22. A span (*vitasti*) is half a cubit (*hasta*). *Anubhāṣya*: *tāta* is the warmth which shows that life still remains in the body. ↩
23. *Anubhāṣya*: *śrī* is beauty: both the beauty and the joints of His arms and legs gave way, leaving their places; *madayati* — "gladdens, fills with bliss". ↩
24. *Kyā kara, kibā* is Hindustani (*keyā karo, keṁo*): "What are you doing? Why?" (*Anubhāṣya*). In half-external consciousness, the Lord asks why people have gathered around Him. ↩
25. So in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: *pāni-śaṅkha*. The *Anubhāṣya* explains *pāṇi-śaṅkha* as a conch held in the hand and blown (or the clapping of hands when the temple doors are opened), and, by another reading, *pānī-śaṅkha*, a conch [holding water] for *ācamana*. ↩
26. Heading in the edition: the transcendental signs of feelings directed to Adhokṣaja are beyond the grasp of those whose knowledge is born of the senses. ↩
27. *Anubhāṣya*: Caṭaka-parvata is a high sand hill that looks like a mountain — a dune. ↩
28. The same verse as Madhya 18.34; translated as there. According to the *Anubhāṣya*, the gopīs sing this verse: wandering in longing for Kṛṣṇa, they see before them Govardhana, the king of mountains. ↩
29. *Anubhāṣya*: the eight sāttvika transformations are stupor, perspiration, hair standing on end, faltering of the voice, trembling, change of colour, tears and loss of consciousness. ↩
30. So in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: *sakhī-gaṇa cāhe keha phula uṭhāite*, "some of the sakhīs wanted to gather flowers"; other editions read *sakhī-gaṇa kahe more phula uṭhāite*, "the sakhīs told Me to gather flowers". ↩
31. *Anubhāṣya*: *caṭaka-giri-rāja* is a mountain that appears as a sand hill; *avadhṛtaḥ* — "followed from behind" (by Svarūpa and the others); *madayati* — "fills with bliss". ↩
32. So in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: *ke bujhite pāre*, "who can understand"; other editions read *ke varṇite pāre*, "who can describe". ↩
33. Heading in the edition: only by following the Lord in His separation from Kṛṣṇa does the soul attain Kṛṣṇa's feet. ↩